

CASE ID: 202503710002a

EPISODE NAME: China Retaliates Against US Tariff Increase

2025/03/04 - Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: United States (2)

Issue: Retaliation (16)

Final Outcome: Ongoing

Narrative:

On 2025/03/04, China imposed tariffs as high as 15 percent on various US agricultural products.¹ China also placed 15 US companies on its export-control list, and 10 US companies on its unreliable entities list.² These measures were taken in response to the US increasing import tariffs on all Chinese products to 20 percent the same day.³

The sanctions represented an escalation in the US-China trade war. A month earlier, the two countries had traded 10%-15% tariffs and various other trade restrictions following president Donald Trump's inauguration.⁴

On 2025/05/12, the Chinese government agreed to reduce their tariffs as the United States would follow at the same time. Both nations agreed to keep a 10% blanket tariff and a 90 day suspension for the retaliation tariffs.⁵ Another round of negotiations on 2025/11/10 reduced Chinese countermeasures further.⁶ Some trade restrictions remain in place.

¹ "China slaps extra tariffs of up to 15% on imports of major US farm exports and adds trade limits." *Associated Press*, 4 March 2025.

<https://apnews.com/article/china-us-tariffs-farm-soy-trump-7442b02ac829347f0d4fc6ad0955d368>

² Lin, Liza. "China Adds 15 American Companies to Export-Control List." *The Wall Street Journal*, March 4th, 2025. <https://www.wsj.com/livecoverage/trump-tariffs-canada-mexico-china>.

³ Boak, Josh, et al. "Trump's Long-Threatened Tariffs against Canada and Mexico Are Now in Effect, Kicking off Trade War." *AP News*, March 4th, 2025.

apnews.com/article/trump-tariffs-canada-mexico-china-643086a6dc7ff716d876b3c83e3255b0.

⁴ Boak, Josh, et al. "Trump Puts Tariffs on Canada, Mexico and China, Spurring Trade War as North American Allies Respond." *AP News*, 2 Feb. 2025,

apnews.com/article/trump-tariffs-trade-china-mexico-canada-inflation-753a09d56cd318f2eb1d2efe3c43b7d4.

⁵ Joseph Stepansky. "Trump tariffs updates: China hit with 145% duties as Wall Street slides." *Aljazeera*, April 10th, 2025.

<https://www.aljazeera.com/economy/liveblog/2025/4/10/trump-tariffs-live-stocks-skyrocket-as-many-duties-paused>.

⁶ Huld, Arendse Qian Zhou. "US and China Reach Trade Concessions Following Trump-Xi Meeting: Outcomes and Implications." *China Briefing*, 10 Nov. 2025.

<https://www.china-briefing.com/news/trump-xi-meeting-outcomes-and-implications>